

Phishing Awareness Training

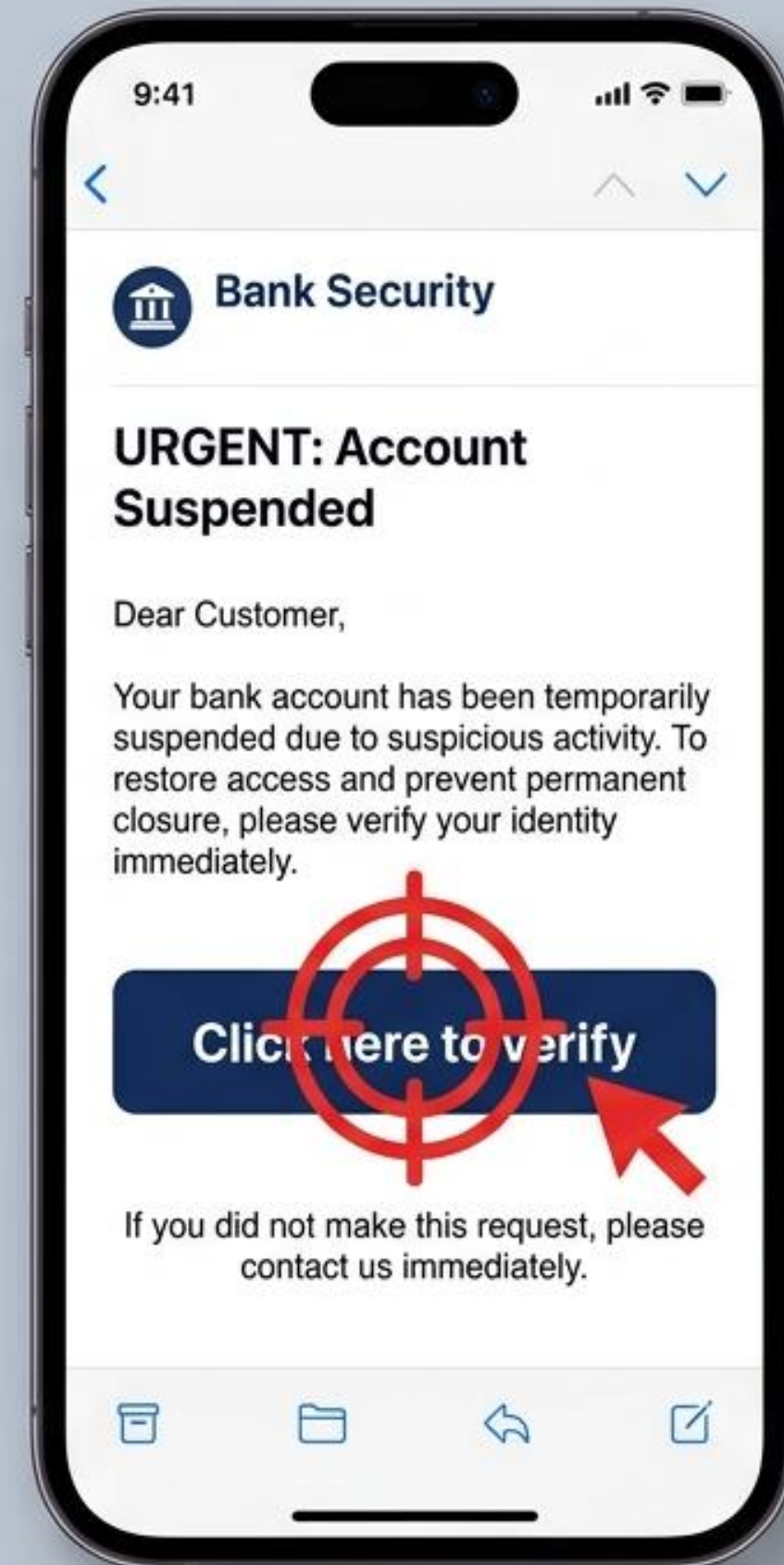
CodeAlpha Cyber Security Internship

Prepared by: Anuska Swain | Task 2 Submission



What is Phishing?

A cybercrime where attackers impersonate legitimate organisations via email, text, or phone to steal sensitive information like passwords and financial details.



Types of Phishing



Email Phishing

Mass, untargeted fraudulent emails sent to thousands of users.



Spear Phishing

Highly personalised attacks aimed at a specific individual using gathered intelligence.



Whaling

High-stakes targeted attacks aimed at senior executives to authorise wire transfers.



Smishing

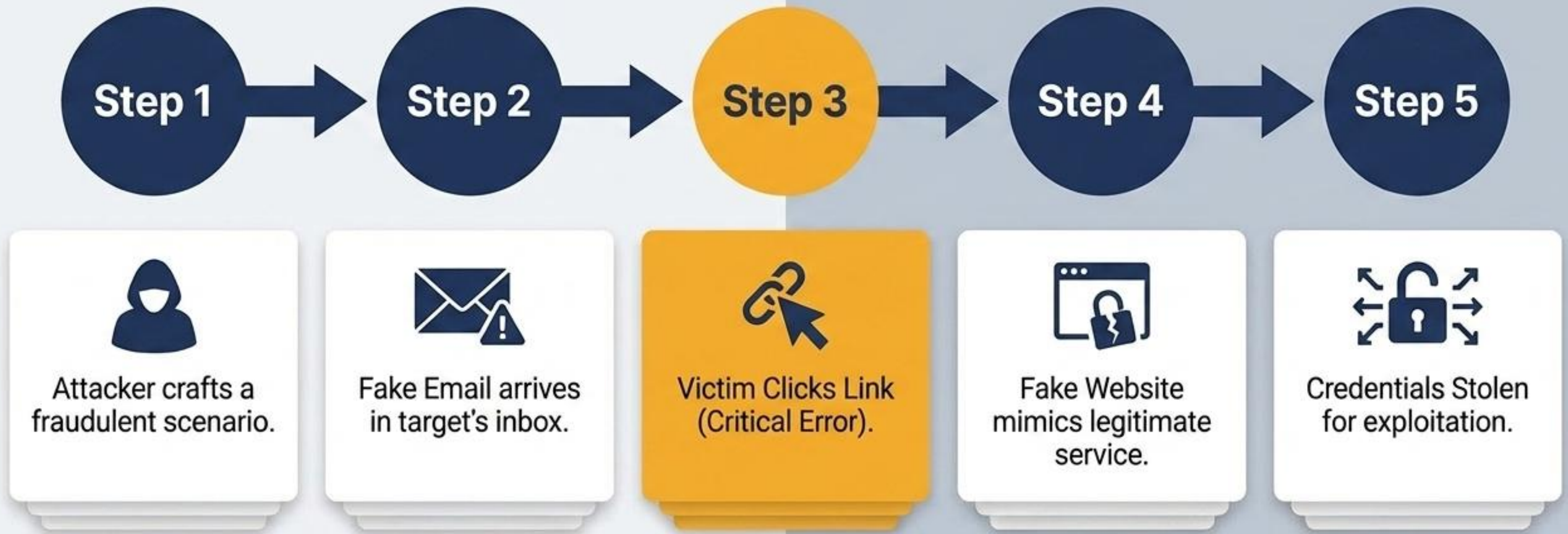
Phishing executed via SMS text messages containing malicious links.



Vishing

Voice phishing over phone calls, creating immediate pressure and panic.

How Phishing Works: The Attack Lifecycle



How to Recognise Phishing Emails

Unknown Sender:

Domain doesn't match the company.

From: IT Helpdesk <admin@it-support-update24.com>

Subject: Account will be deleted in 24 hours

Urgent Language:

Artificial pressure to act.

Dear user, you must act **immediatly**.

Grammar Mistakes:

Poor spelling or phrasing.

Download the attached [update.zip](#) to secure your password.

Suspicious Attachment:

Unexpected .zip or .exe files.

Fake Links:

Hovering reveals mismatched URLs.

Requests for Passwords:

Legitimate organisations never ask for this.

Diagnostic Comparison: Fake Website Example



←  https://amaz0n-security.com



Uses a zero ('0') instead of the letter 'o'.



Appends unnecessary words ('-security').



← → ↻  https://amazon.in



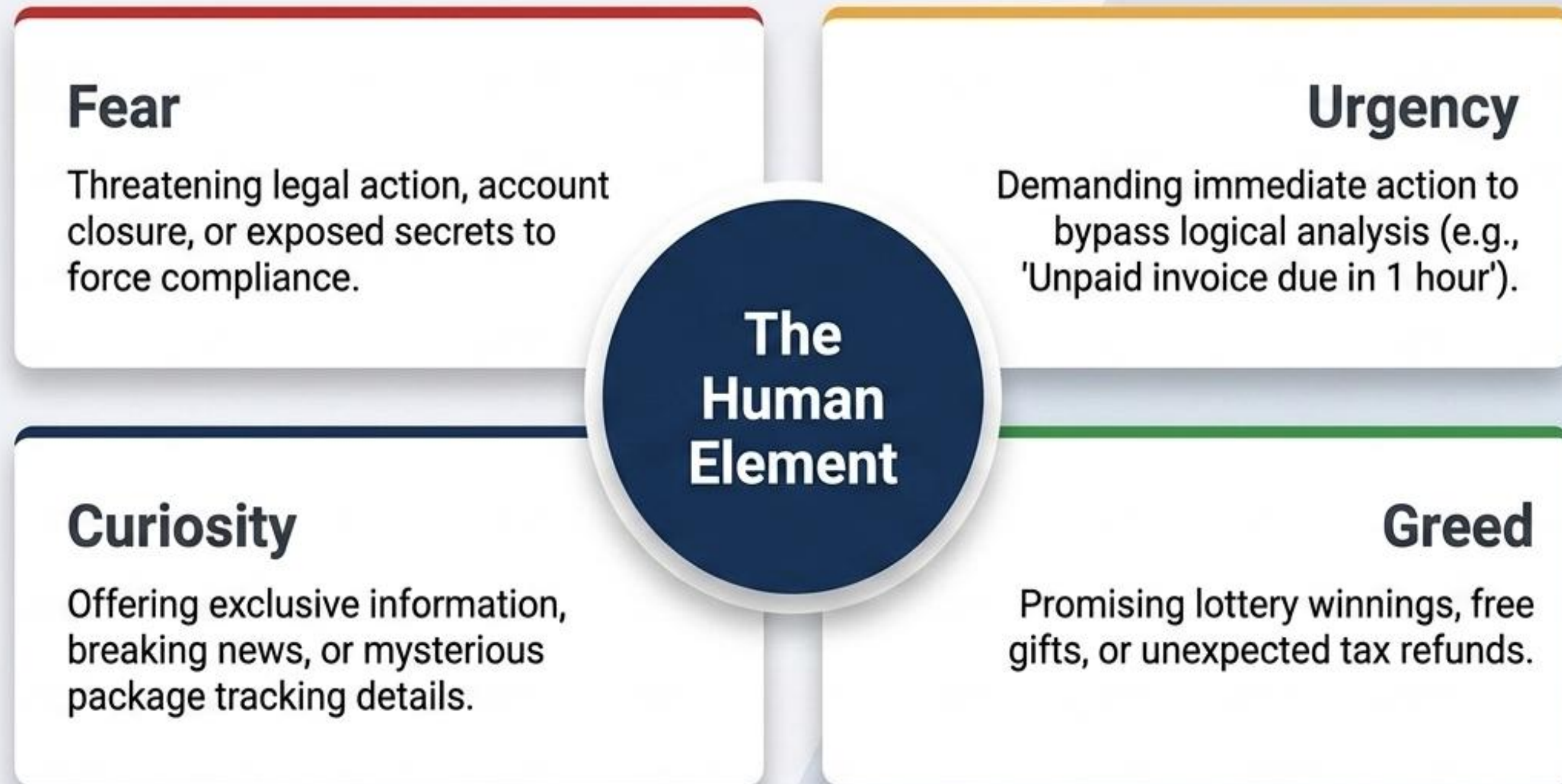
Correct spelling of the brand name.



Clean, official top-level domain.

Key Insight: Always inspect the exact URL string in your browser's address bar before entering credentials.

Social Engineering: The Psychological Mechanics



Defence Layers & Best Practices

Verify Sender

Double-check exact email addresses, not just display names.



Check URLs

Always hover your cursor over links before clicking to reveal the destination.



Keep Software Updated

Patch web browsers and operating systems regularly.



Use MFA

Enable Multi-Factor Authentication everywhere to render stolen passwords useless.



Think Before Clicking

Treat any unexpected link or attachment with zero trust.

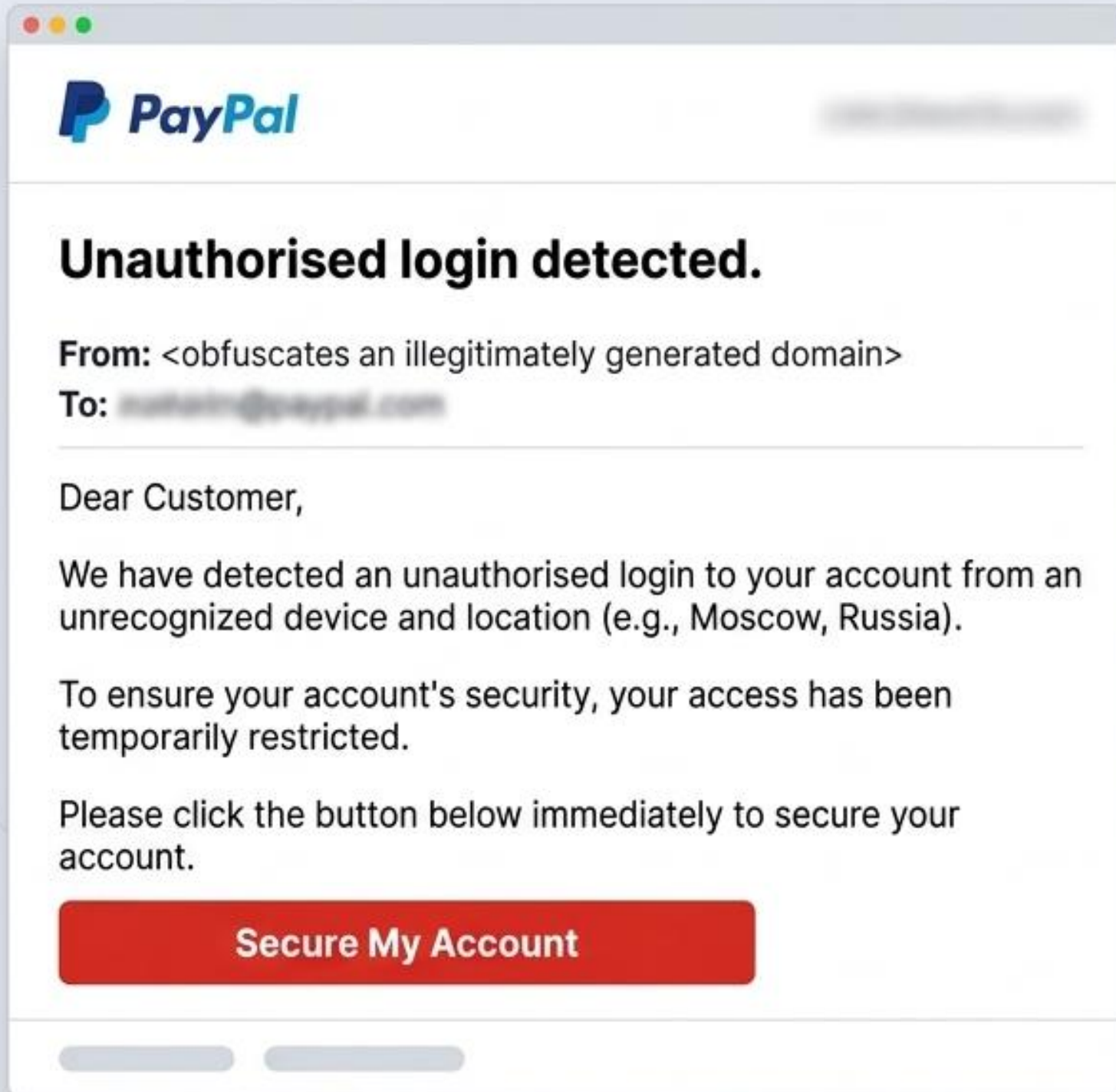


Strong Passwords

Use unique, complex passphrases managed by a password manager.



Real-World Anatomy: The PayPal Scam



The Setup: Victim receives an official-looking email warning that their account was accessed from a foreign country.



The Trap: Panic sets in. The victim clicks the prominent button, directing them to a fake domain: **paypa1-resolution.com**.



The Exploit: The spoofed site asks for their current password to 'verify' their identity, handing the credentials directly to the attacker.



The Lesson: Never use resolution links in an email. Always open a fresh browser tab and type the official website manually.

Threat Detection Simulation

Your bank texts you a link to stop a fraudulent charge.

A. Safe

B. Suspicious (Smishing)

An email from the CEO asks for a quick, confidential wire transfer.

A. Safe

B. Suspicious (Whaling)

You hover over an Amazon link, but the URL shows amaz0n-deals.net.

A. Click

B. Don't Click

A website URL reads
www.microsoft-update-critical.com.

A. Real

B. Fake

You receive a password reset email you didn't request.

A. Ignore

B. Reset it

Key Takeaways



Trust Your Instincts

If an email feels excessively urgent, threatening, or too good to be true, your baseline assumption should be that it is a trap.



Verify Independently

Never rely on contact information or hyperlinks provided within a suspicious message. Find the official website yourself.



Layer Your Defences

Combine constant personal vigilance with automated technical tools, especially Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA).

Thank You

Questions?

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